

Texas Mineral Ownership Data - Pilot Summary

Location Intelligence pilot | July 2026
Question: Can Texas mineral ownership data be harvested from county records at small scale, and what limits apply at scale?

Executive Answer

Yes - small-scale county index harvest is confirmed. Mineral ownership lives in county clerk Official Public Records (deeds, reservations, O&G leases, assignments), not in RRC well data. There is no statewide API; 254 counties use different vendors. Scale is an engineering + money problem, not an impossible wall - except for pre-digitization records that exist only in books or microfilm.

Harvest Proof (Demonstrated)

Source	Result	Notes
Courthouse index (GovOS)	150 rows	Reeves + Midland via browser search
Mineral-related subset	16 rows	MINERAL DEED, CONVEYANCE, O&G LEASE, etc.
Example record	2019017441	NEECE JOHN R -> BRIGHAM MINERALS LLC MINERAL DEED 10/22/2019
RRC wells (not ownership)	100+ rows	Midland api165.dbf + 200 GIS wells

Plain HTTP scraping of GovOS portals returns no index rows. Browser automation works. Output: data/samples/courthouse_mineral_index_harvest.csv
Re-run: python scripts/harvest_courthouse_demo.py

Where Mineral Ownership Actually Lives

- County Clerk OPR: mineral deeds, reservations, O&G leases, royalty deeds, probates
- NOT RRC: wells, permits, production (regulatory activity only)
- NOT BLM MLRS: federal lease counts (spatial), not private title
- Vendors aggregate counties: CourthouseDirect, TexasFile, Enverus

Limits Matrix

Type	Detail	Severity	Workaround
Technical	JS portals, no shared API, bot throttling	Soft	Browser automation or bulk FTP
Pay	Index often free; images ~\$1/page; bulk FTP fees	Real cost	Reeves \$50/wk; Harris Data Sales
Legal	Facts are public record; vendor ToS may restrict bots	Soft	PIA request or clerk permission
Hard gap	Pre-digitization books/microfilm only	Hard	In-person imaging or paid vendor

County Fragmentation

Each county is its own integration. Examples from pilot:

- GovOS/Neumo: Reeves, Midland, Tarrant, Collin, Denton (publicsearch.us)
- Tyler: Rockwall (tylerhost.net)
- Custom: Harris (ccclerk.hctx.net)

No Texas mineral rights API exists.

Key Clerk Contacts (Bulk / Data Sales)

County	Email	Phone	Bulk notes
Reeves	countyclerk@reevescounty.org	432-287-0222	FTP \$50/wk or \$200/mo
Harris	datasales@cco.hctx.net	713-274-6390	Pipe index + TIFF; monthly FTP
Fort Bend	cclerkrecords@fortbendcountytexas.gov	281-341-8685	FTP \$10-20/mo + \$50 setup
Tarrant	wm-countyclerk@tarrantcountytexas.gov	817-884-1069	Pay online, call to finish
Midland	ccland@co.midland.tx.us	432-688-4401	Ask for bulk/PIA terms
Dallas	recording@dallascounty.org	214-653-7099	Large batches; PIA via CC-Inquiry@

What to Ask Clerks

1. Machine-readable OPR index export (CSV/pipe-delimited)? Fields included?
2. Filter by doc type (mineral deed, O&G lease, assignment, royalty)?
3. Bulk images (TIFF/PDF) available separately or bundled?
4. FTP/SFTP subscription? Setup fee, update frequency, incremental vs full?
5. Electronic coverage date range? Any index-only or missing-image periods?
6. Fee schedule and turnaround? Sample file or data dictionary available?

Recommended Next Steps

1. Purchase Reeves weekly FTP (\$50) as cheapest bulk proof from source
2. Email Harris Data Sales and Midland ccland for bulk index quotes
3. Pilot 3-5 counties via browser harvest OR bulk purchase (not both everywhere)
4. Join RRC well data to courthouse leases by legal description (expect fuzzy matches)
5. For statewide scale: evaluate CourthouseDirect or TexasFile vs build county-by-county

Related Project Files

reports/Courthouse_Contact_Outreach.md - full contact guide
 reports/Mineral_Rights_Harvest_and_Limits_Report.pdf - detailed limits catalog
 reports/Texas_Mineral_Rights_Data_Strategy.pdf - three-tier build/buy plan
 data/samples/courthouse_mineral_index_harvest.csv - live harvest sample
 data/samples/courthouse_contacts.csv - contact spreadsheet